File No.: 9/7/2026/CD(Cen)-Media

भारत सरकार/Government of India

गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs

भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय

Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India

जनगणना प्रभाग/Census Division

2/A, Mansingh Road, New Delhi-110011

Dated: 19-03-2026

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 - CIRCULAR No. 17

Subject: Publicity for Census of India 2027

Preparations for the smooth conduct of the Houselisting Operations for the Census of India 2027 are in full swing across all States/UTs. In most States/UTs, the appointment of Census Officers including Principal Census Officers, District Census Officers and Census Charge Officers has been completed. The Houselisting Operations are scheduled for April–September 2026, and the training of Census functionaries has already commenced.

2. For the successful enumeration in 2027, it is crucial that adequate publicity measures are undertaken to raise awareness among people about the Census. Past experience demonstrates that pre-emptive publicity campaigns, emphasizing both the importance of participation and the questions enumerators will ask, significantly enhance people's cooperation. Such efforts also help in establishing rapport with people, ensuring a warm positive reception for enumerators during household visits.

3. The publicity campaign will not only inform people about the questions to be canvassed in the two phases of the Census 2027 but also reassure them that all information provided is legally confidential, fostering trust and confidence in the process. Utilizing a mix of media, including radio, television, newspapers, and social media will be

instrumental in sensitizing the public and ensuring accurate data collection, as demonstrated in previous censuses.

4. The publicity campaign for the first phase of Census 2027 would begin about 15 to 20 days' prior to the Houselisting exercise and would continue throughout the period. As this exercise would continue for about 45 days in each state/union territory, the pace of the campaign would have to be suitably controlled depending upon the availability of funds.

5. A key element in planning the Census 2027 publicity campaign is the collaboration with the Central Bureau of Communication (CBC), Ministry of Information & Broadcasting (MIB). The CBC has scientifically assessed past practices, evaluated media suitability across regions, and recommended the most effective strategies for maximizing outreach within budgetary constraints. CBC has also suggested the message formats and along with ORGI has supervised the production of audio-visual creatives and print content in scheduled languages. The resulting media plan will guide the publicity strategy for Census 2027.

6. At State-Level Publicity, each Census Directorate will be responsible for additional publicity measures tailored to the unique requirements of the State/UT, using the funds allocated to them. Master creatives for Newspaper, TV Commercials, Radio Jingles, Outdoor Hoardings and digital creatives along with language adaptations shall be shared with the States/UTs, as far as possible. Any further adaptation (dialect/cultural) may be taken up by the DCOs with prior intimation to ORGI. A national campaign shall be rolled during March 2026 following which the State/UT specific campaigns shall be rolled out as per the state specific notified dates. DCOs may ensure that there is no duplicate spending for same resources. A model state campaign to be rolled out from ORGI will be shared which can be augmented by states through their own publicity campaign. This may include wall writings, banners, display boards, wall hangers, public announcements via microphones, van campaigns, bus/railway panel advertisements & ticket messages, inclusion in telephone, electricity or other monthly utility bills. The ingenuity of State Directorates will be essential in

devising an effective publicity strategy in both rural and urban areas. DCOs are empowered to implement strategies within their delegated financial powers; proposals exceeding these powers require ORGI approval.

7. It is also advised that State Directorates may have effective 24/7 teams for handling social media accounts along with content creation capabilities. As the HLO operations begin, it will be crucial to monitor social media narratives around-the-clock for any adverse comments/ propaganda items/ false narratives, so that they can be countered/fact-checked in real time through State/UT Directorate or field functionaries, with intimation to the ORGI.

8. Additionally, State Governments/UT Administrations are encouraged to initiate publicity using their own resources and leverage local government machinery to enhance campaign effectiveness. Utilizing existing state-level communication infrastructure will often be cost-effective and efficient. Census Directorates must document all publicity activities undertaken by ORGI and the DCOs. Teams should collect news articles, audio-visual recordings, and other media outputs as per the media plan for future reference. DCOs are required to submit a comprehensive report on the implementation and impact of the publicity campaign in their State/UT once the exercise concludes.

Narayanm 19/3/2026.

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To
Director of Census Operations (All States/UTs)

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